

Whipped Ricotta with Honey and Walnuts (Variation 3)

Tags: *snack, vegetarian, quick, appetiser, gluten-free* | Prep: 10 min | Cook: 0 min | Serves: 6

Ingredients

- 500 g full-fat ricotta
- 60 g cream cheese, softened
- 2 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1/2 tsp fine salt
- Zest of 1 lemon
- topping: 3 tbsp good honey, 60 g walnuts toasted and roughly chopped, fresh marjoram leaves, extra olive oil, black pepper, flaky sea salt
- Crostini or sourdough to serve

Method

1. Drain ricotta in a fine-mesh sieve for 15 minutes if it looks watery.
2. Place ricotta, cream cheese, olive oil, salt, and lemon zest in a food processor.
3. Process for 2–3 minutes until completely smooth, pale, and airy.
4. Taste and adjust salt and lemon.
5. Transfer to a serving bowl. Use the back of a spoon to create swoops and divots.
6. Drizzle with honey. Scatter walnuts, fresh thyme, and a pinch of flaky salt.
7. Drizzle with extra olive oil and crack over black pepper.
8. Serve immediately with crostini or sourdough toasts.

Chef Tips

- Full-fat ricotta is essential — low-fat versions are too watery and won't whip properly.
- Processing for 2+ minutes transforms the grainy texture into something incredibly silky.
- The combination of good honey and flaky salt is what makes this simple dish sing.